

Tender workflow automation · East Africa

Win more tenders. Without the admin..

Gulawo takes East African SME contractors from tender discovery to a compliant, priced submission — and gives buyers a block-based builder and evaluation workflow.

Gulawo · Pitch Deck · 2026

The problem

Government and corporate tenders are the fastest-growing revenue channel for East African SMEs — but most lose them for reasons unrelated to ability.

Fragmented discovery

Tenders are scattered across PPDA, e-GP, World Bank and corporate portals in 4 countries. Teams miss opportunities daily.

Disqualifying paperwork

Missing certificates, wrong bid security, expired TINs. One missing box = automatic disqualification, no matter how good the bid.

Deadlines & manual work

Spreads in Excel, documents in folders, no alerts. Bids die silently.

For buyers: no pipeline

Procurement teams rebuild tender documents from scratch and evaluate bids in spreadsheets.

The solution

One platform for the entire bid journey — discovery → qualification → pricing → submission — plus the buyer side that issues and evaluates the tenders.



Contractors

Live matched feed, compliance matrix, deviation scanner, AI proposals, kanban pipeline, automation.



Buyers & entities

Block-based tender builder, conditional logic, reusable templates, applicant tracking, weighted bid evaluation.

Market: TAM · SAM · SOM

Top-down: public procurement spend across Uganda, Kenya, Tanzania & Rwanda exceeds **\$20B/year**. Bottom-up: ~100,000+ active SME contractors chasing ~4,000+ live tenders across our sources at any time.

\$20B+

TAM

Total public procurement spend across the 4 markets

~\$4B

SAM

SME-addressable contracts — works, goods & services within SME capability

\$40–80M

SOM

Realistic 3–5 year capture at 1–2% of SAM via subscriptions & fees

Why now: procurement is digitizing, mobile money has normalized online SME payments, and regional tenders are growing — while no dedicated workflow tool exists for these markets.

Contractor workflow & AI

- ✓ Live tender feed from official sources (PPDA, e-GP, World Bank, TED) — matched and scored to each company
- ✓ Compliance matrix: every SBD requirement extracted into a checklist
- ✓ Deviation scanner that flags anything that would disqualify your bid before you submit
- ✓ AI proposal writer grounded in real capabilities and past performance; auditable Dash AI agent
- ✓ Kanban pipeline with weighted value, next-best-action chips, and deadline automation

Buyer side: post & evaluate



Block-based builder

Headers, requirements, scoring criteria, document uploads, conditionals and tables — assembled like Notion.



Evaluation

Score submitted bids against your own weighted criteria in a color-coded matrix with ranking.

Conditional logic

"If estimated value > 500M, require an extra financial guarantee."
Evaluated automatically.

Reusable templates

Save standard sections and reuse them across tenders — stop rebuilding from scratch.

Traction

1,000+

tenders indexed from official
sources

4

countries live

5+

automated sources

24/7

sync, alerts & agents

Live product, demo-ready, with a full contractor pipeline and a buyer-side tender publishing & evaluation workspace already built.

Business model



Contractors — freemium

Free discovery; Business & Pro tiers for AI proposals, pricing, automation and reports.



Buyers — per-tender

Free first listing; subscription for the builder, templates and evaluation.

Value pricing in local currencies

UGX / KES / TZS / RWF with mobile-money-friendly pricing.

Land & expand

Land contractors free, monetize on submissions; buyers pay for volume and workflow.

Financials (illustrative)

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Paying contractors	200	1,500	6,000
Paying buyers	20	120	400
Blended monthly ARPU (contractor)	\$15	\$18	\$20
Annual revenue	~\$60k	~\$500k	~\$2.2M
Gross margin (SaaS)	~85%	~85%	~85%
Team	2–3	8	18

Illustrative projections to be refined with beta data. Seed round funds the tender engine, buyer onboarding and market expansion — targeting break-even by end of Year 3.

Competition & our moat

We compete with spreadsheets & portals

Existing players are either listing portals (discovery only) or generic forms. No one owns compliance-to-submission workflow for this region.

Two-sided network

Contractor bidding AND buyer publishing/evaluation on one platform — compounding data and network effects.

Regional depth

Official local sources, local currencies, local compliance rules, local buyer workflows.

Compliance engine

The deviation scanner and compliance matrix are the moat — hard to replicate, and the #1 SME pain point.

The ask

Raising a seed round to scale the tender engine, onboard buyer accounts, and grow the contractor base across the four markets.

- ✓ Grow the live tender index and refine matching accuracy
- ✓ Convert early contractor and buyer accounts into paying customers
- ✓ Expand to more sources and more East African markets

Let's build the tender OS for East Africa

gulawo.com

Try it free · Watch the demo · Request a walkthrough

Mark Nkugwa
Founder

nkugwamarkwilliam@gmail.com
Kampala, Uganda